

90-DAY SOFTWARE TESTING CAREER ROADMAP

Exploratory Testing Charter Template

Focus an exploratory session with a clear mission and notes.

Introduction

A charter turns "have a look around" into a focused exploratory mission. It states what you will explore, to discover what, using which approach — and gives you a place to capture findings.

Instructions

- Write the charter: explore [target] to discover [information] using [approach].
- Time-box the session (e.g. 45 minutes).
- Pick a persona or risk angle to focus your exploration.
- Take notes: what you tried, observed, bugs, and new questions.

Real QA Example

Field	Example
Charter	Explore checkout to discover failure-handling issues using invalid and interrupted payments
Time-box	45 minutes
Persona	Impatient mobile user on poor signal
Areas	Card errors, dropped connection, double submit, back button
Findings	Double-charge possible on rapid resubmit (logged BUG-31)

Blank Reusable Template

Field	Detail
Charter	Explore ___ to discover ___ using ___
Time-box	
Persona / angle	

Field	Detail
Areas to cover	
What I tried	
Observations	
Bugs found	
New questions	

Best Practice Tips

- Pair the charter with a persona or risk for sharper focus.
- Time-box and take notes — sessions should be reportable.
- Follow your curiosity, but stay within the charter.

Common Mistakes

- Vague charters that do not focus the session.
- No notes, so findings cannot be reported or repeated.
- Treating exploratory testing as random clicking.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Your charters and session notes are portfolio artefacts. They show structured curiosity — exactly what senior testers are valued for.